

application is a good choice for people looking for open source alternatives to commercial proprietary burners. The interface and list of features offered by InfraRecorder is at par with that offered by its commercial counterparts.

2.3 Open source resources for education

2.3.1 Educational institution administration

Open admin for schools (<http://richtech.ca/openadmin/index.html>)

This is a web service that needs to be installed on a web server. You can test how this works with its demo page available on the home page. The application offers extensive data collection capabilities to monitor every aspect of a student's performance. The interface is designed to address the concerns of different types of users – school manager/principal, teachers and parents. The School manager's page allows creating and modifying different aspects of running a school such as setting fees, creating a schedule and managing enrolments.

DID YOU KNOW?

64 Studio is a Linux distro targeted at multimedia professionals. You can download this distro at www.64studio.com

Similarly, the Teacher's view allows finer control of a student's activities – recording attendance and marks. The Parents view allows viewing the progress card of the ward online. (takes the fun out of "report card day")

From a non-pro's view, the options on the pages are esoteric, but considering that the application has been accepted in many schools all over the world – on the website, among the list of schools using this application, close to 600 Indian schools are listed – a education pro may find all bases covered.

2.3.2 Course management systems

Moodle (<http://www.moodle.org>)

A courseware management tool such as Moodle is primarily used to manage an educational organisation's "product". Moodle is a web service and requires a web server to run. It's a relatively complex application probably because of the many features it sports. Some training is required for new users. Pros who have cut their teeth on content management systems, would feel right at home in Moodle.